

Activity 3: Breaking the System

Step 1: Use Your Existing System

Use the Project (or skill) you built in Activity 2.

Step 2: Try to Break It

Don't use normal inputs. Try edge cases:

- Vague input: "Help with resume"
- Ambiguous input: "Make this better"
- Off-context: "Write a resignation email"
- Conflicting request: "Make it detailed but under 10 words"
- Real messy input: "i did some marketing stuff idk what to say"

Step 3: Observe Failures

- Did the system still behave correctly?
- Did it ignore constraints?
- Did it hallucinate or assume things?
- Did it default to generic answers?

Step 4: Diagnose the Problem

Map failures back to ICCO:

- Instruction unclear?
- Context missing?
- Constraints too weak?
- Output format inconsistent?

Step 5: Fix the System

Improve your design:

- Add guardrails ("If input is vague, ask clarifying question")
- Tighten constraints
- Clarify scope ("Only respond to resume-related tasks")

Step 6: Re-test

Run the same "bad inputs" again.

Point for reflection:

- Did it fail less?
- Is behaviour more consistent?
- Does it handle edge cases better?

Note: If you have completed, try to partner up and break (improve) your partner's system.